**API Usage Budget Proposal**
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# API Usage Budget Proposal

RADIX AI Content Planner — Recurring API Costs for Finance Approval

## 01 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The RADIX AI Content Planner automates social media content creation across our portfolio of **13 active clients**. The content team currently dedicates **600+ manual hours per month** to content planning, copywriting, visual direction, and scheduling. This tool compresses that workflow to minutes per client by leveraging AI-powered text generation, image creation, video production, and visual reference search.

API costs represent the **only recurring operational expense** for the tool. All infrastructure runs locally within the existing Radix technology stack. No additional headcount, hardware, or software licenses are required.

> **Total Annual Budget Request:** $854 – $996 depending on team size (6–7 users), inclusive of a 15% cost buffer for API pricing fluctuations. This represents a **241x return on investment** against current manual labor costs.

## 02 API SERVICES OVERVIEW

The Content Planner integrates five API services across text, image, video, and reference search capabilities:

| SERVICE | PROVIDER | MODEL | USE CASE | PER-UNIT COST |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Text Content Generation | Anthropic | Claude Opus 4 | Generate 18 content pieces from client brief | $5/M input tokens<br>$25/M output tokens |
| Text Analysis & Keywords | Google | Gemini 2.5 Flash | Keyword generation, prompt analysis | $0.30/M input<br>$2.50/M output |
| Image Generation | Google | Gemini 3.1 Flash Image | Visual references, social media images | $0.067/image (1K resolution) |

| SERVICE | PROVIDER | MODEL | USE CASE | PER-UNIT COST |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | (Nano Banana 2) | | |
| Video Generation | Google | Veo 3.1 | Short-form video content (10s) | $1.50/video |
| Visual Reference Search | Wikimedia Foundation | Commons API | Stock photo references for designers | FREE (500 req/hr) |

## 03 USAGE ASSUMPTIONS

**6–7**
ACTIVE USERS (SOCIAL MEDIA TEAM)

**~2**
CONTENT BRIEFS PER USER / MONTH

**18**
CONTENT PIECES PER BRIEF (36/USER/MO)

**~20**
AI-GENERATED IMAGES PER USER / MONTH

**~5**
AI-GENERATED VIDEOS PER USER / MONTH

**~70**
VISUAL REFERENCE LOOKUPS PER USER / MONTH

## 04 MONTHLY COST BREAKDOWN

### Scenario A — 6 Users

| LINE ITEM | QUANTITY | UNIT COST | MONTHLY TOTAL |
|---|---|---|---|
| Claude Opus 4 — Content Generation | 12 briefs (6 users × 2) | $0.73/brief | $8.76 |
| Gemini 2.5 Flash — Text Analysis | 12 briefs | ~$0.005/brief | $0.06 |
| Gemini 3.1 Flash Image — Image Generation | 120 images (6 × 20) | $0.067/image | $8.04 |
| Veo 3.1 — Video Generation | 30 videos (6 × 5) | $1.50/video | $45.00 |
| Wikimedia Commons — Visual References | ~420 lookups | FREE | $0.00 |
| **TOTAL MONTHLY (6 USERS)** | | | **$61.86** |

### Scenario B — 7 Users

| LINE ITEM | QUANTITY | UNIT COST | MONTHLY TOTAL |
|---|---|---|---|
| Claude Opus 4 — Content Generation | 14 briefs (7 users × 2) | $0.73/brief | $10.22 |
| Gemini 2.5 Flash — Text Analysis | 14 briefs | ~$0.005/brief | $0.07 |
| Gemini 3.1 Flash Image — Image Generation | 140 images (7 × 20) | $0.067/image | $9.38 |
| Veo 3.1 — Video Generation | 35 videos (7 × 5) | $1.50/video | $52.50 |
| Wikimedia Commons — Visual References | ~490 lookups | FREE | $0.00 |
| **TOTAL MONTHLY (7 USERS)** | | | **$72.17** |

## 05 ANNUAL PROJECTIONS

| SCENARIO | MONTHLY | ANNUAL (12 MO) | + 15% BUFFER | TOTAL BUDGET REQUEST |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **6 Users** | $61.86 | $742.32 | $111.35 | **$854.00** |
| **7 Users** | $72.17 | $866.04 | $129.91 | **$996.00** |

## 06 RETURN ON INVESTMENT

The following analysis compares current manual content planning costs against the proposed API expenditure:

| | |
|---|---|
| Current Manual Cost (600+ hrs/mo × $25/hr avg) | **$15,000+/month** |
| AI Content Planner API Cost (6 users) | **~$62/month** |
| Monthly Cost Reduction | **$14,938+** |
| Return on Investment | **241x** |
| Payback Period | **Immediate** |

Note: The 241x ROI reflects API costs only. The tool reallocates content team hours toward higher-value activities (client strategy, campaign analysis, creative direction) rather than eliminating headcount. The net productivity gain across 13 clients is substantial.

## 07 BUDGET APPROVAL

This document requests approval for a recurring annual API budget as outlined in Section 05. Signatories below confirm review and authorization of the stated expenditure.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Prepared by**<br>Head of AI and Digital Transformation | NAME<br>Mohamed | SIGNATURE | DATE |
| **Reviewed by**<br>Finance Manager | NAME | SIGNATURE | DATE |
| **Approved by**<br>General Manager | NAME | SIGNATURE | DATE |

**Notes & Disclaimers**

- All prices quoted as of April 2026. Anthropic and Google may adjust pricing at any time; the 15% budget buffer accounts for potential increases.
- Video generation (Veo 3.1) is the dominant cost driver, accounting for approximately 73% of total monthly spend. This can be reduced by switching to Veo 3.1 Lite at 50% lower cost.
- Free-tier services (Wikimedia Commons) operate with generous rate limits (500 requests/hour) well above projected usage.
- API keys are stored securely within the application and access is restricted to authorized content team members only.
- No client data is stored by third-party API providers. All content generation is stateless and session-based.



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